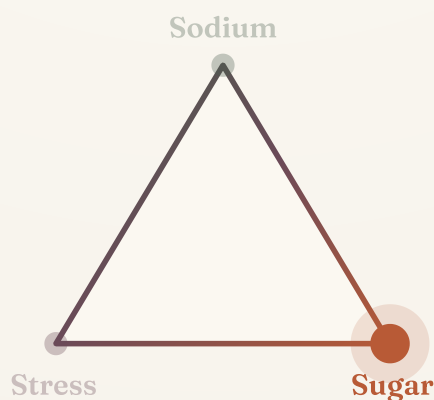


SUGAR CORNER . HERB FORMULARY



The Sugar Corner Herb Formulary

The herbs I trust for this corner, each with its dose, why it helps, and the cautions that matter.

by Joel Polley, RN

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THE BP TRIANGLE . STRESS . SUGAR . SODIUM

The Sugar Corner Herb Formulary

These are the metabolic herbs for the sugar corner, chosen to help the body use insulin again rather than to force a number down. They are education to discuss with your doctor or pharmacist, not a prescription, and they work alongside your medical care, never instead of it. If you take diabetes medication or insulin, talk to your prescriber before you begin: these botanicals lower blood sugar on purpose, and stacked on medication they can push it too low. That decision belongs to your doctor, who can watch your improving numbers and decide whether anything needs adjusting.

THE ONE RULE THAT GOVERNS EVERY HERB HERE

Add ONE at a time. Check your blood pressure daily. Tell your doctor everything you are taking. If you are on BP medication these can lower your pressure further, which is the goal under monitoring; if readings run consistently below about 110/70 or you feel dizzy, call your doctor about your medication dose. Never stop or change a prescription on your own.

The Formulary

Herb / nutrient	Dose / use	Why it helps	Caution
Berberine The AMPK activator	500 mg, one to three times daily, with meals. Many people start at 500 mg once daily with the largest meal and build up over several days so the gut can adjust.	Activates AMPK, the same cellular pathway the drug metformin works on, helping cells take up glucose and improving insulin sensitivity. It sensitizes the lock to the key.	Strong glucose-lowering effect, so combined with medication there is a real risk of going too low (tell your doctor). Interacts with many prescriptions because it shares a liver metabolism pathway (the CYP3A4 system). Can cause loose stools or cramping at first; take with food and build slowly. Avoid in pregnancy and while nursing.
Cinnamon The post-meal steadier	About 1 to 2 grams daily, or a standardized supplement per its label. Choose Ceylon cinnamon for daily use.	Supports steadier post-meal glucose and adds to insulin receptor sensitivity.	The cheaper cassia type contains coumarin, which in large daily amounts can stress the liver, so Ceylon is the gentler daily choice. Mild additive glucose-lowering effect with diabetes medication.
Chromium (chromium picolinate) The insulin helper	200 to 400 mcg daily, with food.	A trace mineral that helps insulin work more effectively at the cell.	Generally well tolerated. Mild additive glucose-lowering effect with diabetes medication. Talk to your doctor if you have kidney concerns.

Daily supports (free, and the backbone)

The levers that do the heavy lifting (the herbs are the assist, not the engine): a 20-minute morning walk within an hour of waking to open the insulin-independent glucose door in your

muscles; fiber-first meals (vegetables and beans before the grain) to blunt the spike; and, eased in gently and cleared with your doctor first if you take glucose-lowering medication, two meals a day about five to six hours apart with the kitchen closed after supper, so insulin finally gets to rest.

A TRANSPARENT NOTE

A note on this formulary: the source document for this corner names exactly three botanicals in the metabolic stack, berberine, cinnamon, and chromium. The kit brief referenced "Joel's 5 metabolic herbs," so there is a gap of two. Rather than invent two herbs and doses that have not been vetted, this formulary ships the three that are sourced and verified. If a five-herb stack is intended, the two additions and their doses need to come from Joel before they go in.

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